

THE PEACEFUL CO-PARENT

TABLES

BILL OF RIGHTS & COMMITMENTS

The Mission

Do yourself and your kid(s) a favor and de-stress your life post-relationship.



WHAT I MISS	MY FEELINGS ABOUT IT

SAMPLE

WHAT I MISS	MY FEELINGS ABOUT IT
<i>The loving moments; the sharing; the warmth; the connection; physical affection</i>	<i>Feeling connected to someone special feels great</i>

WHAT I DON'T MISS	MY FEELINGS ABOUT IT

SAMPLE

WHAT I DON'T MISS	MY FEELINGS ABOUT IT
Abuse or abusive comments	I felt disrespected and tense; also that if I didn't insult her back then I'd be perceived as weak (I often did not insult her back and sometimes resented both her and myself for this inaction).
Arguments	I felt tense and anxious that we were not connected and that we risked becoming further disconnected.
Lack of intimacy and connection	I felt unwanted, not sexually appealing, under-confident and that I was somehow predatory because I actually wanted to have sex with my wife.
Not having space	I felt overwhelmed by the lack of space to work on myself. I also felt that if I expressed the need for space it would be perceived as weak because I wasn't completely clear on my life's direction at all times.
Feeling like I wasn't showing up as the best version of myself	I often felt frustrated, like I didn't have the opportunity to show my best self because I was too often on the defensive.

WHAT I'VE LEARNED ABOUT MYSELF AS I MOVE ON	MY FEELINGS ABOUT IT

SAMPLE

WHAT I'VE LEARNED ABOUT MYSELF AS I MOVE ON	MY FEELINGS ABOUT IT
<i>Give a voice to my vulnerabilities</i>	<i>I felt and feel relieved when I share my vulnerabilities as I had previously feared being judged as weak. I found Brené Brown useful here. One massive insight for me was that my vulnerabilities were not weaknesses but essential elements of what makes me human – what makes me whole.</i>
<i>How my parents' relationship influenced mine</i>	<i>Initially foolish that I didn't see the early warning signs; relieved that I now understand the mapping.</i>
<i>That sex is one type of validation; I also need to be heard and not interrupted ... for just a couple of minutes sometimes.</i>	<i>Mostly empowered and also disappointed in myself because I didn't fight my corner sooner – I accepted a lot of humiliation for the sake of “keeping the peace.” I held myself back from criticizing at times when I could have done so, thinking to myself, “would I be saying this out of love or cruelty?” Even honesty can be cruel and hurtful, and I didn't want to err on the side of the latter whilst claiming the former.</i>
<i>Structures can work well for me (Bill of Rights and conscious uncoupling) in emotional contexts because they can help me manage some potentially tense interactions.</i>	<i>Empowered but also frustrated when I forget to use the frameworks in difficult moments.</i>
<i>She and I need not be a couple to love and appreciate each other.</i>	<i>Empowered and free to pursue my own path without having the pressure of coming up with the perfect path for the whole family to follow. Path-finding often seemed like my sole responsibility and then I was criticized when it wasn't perfectly planned and executed.</i>

TECHNIQUES WE USE TO COMMUNICATE EFFECTIVELY	MY FEELINGS ABOUT IT

SAMPLE

TECHNIQUES WE USE TO COMMUNICATE EFFECTIVELY	MY FEELINGS ABOUT IT
<i>One technique to control my response is "just keep letting go" - don't get wrapped up in battling. Just let stuff go...</i>	<i>Empowered that I can maintain and respond with a cool head no matter how someone else acts. When energy starts getting uncomfortable, pull back and let go. Maintain centered.</i>
<i>Not expecting my good acts to be reciprocated</i>	<i>One of the things that I struggled with early on was when I felt that my goodwill was not being appreciated or reciprocated. But that's the trap. That's all driven by ego, it's all driven by some expectation that she – anyone – owes me something. She – they – do not.</i>
<i>Sometimes we communicate more effectively by text; other times by speaking.</i>	<i>Affirmed that we are trying to use the most effective communication style in order to achieve the best outcome for ourselves and our children.</i>

My Bill of Rights & Commitments

SAMPLE

My Bill of Rights & Commitments

<i>I have the right to express myself without being interrupted and I commit to giving you space to express yourself without being interrupted.</i>	<i>I have the right to be actively listened to, without the fear of criticism and I commit to actively listen to you, without criticizing you.</i>
<i>I have the right to decline sex or intimacy when I'm not in the mood and I commit to respect your declination of sex or intimacy when you are not in the mood.</i>	<i>I have the right to privacy – emails, social media, socializing, my space and body – without arousing suspicion or negative assumptions and I commit to respect your right to privacy – emails, social media, socializing, your space and body – without feeling suspicion or negative assumptions.</i>
<i>I have the right to disagree with you without it being seen as a criticism or an insult (but only after I have actively listened to you) and I further commit to disagree with you without criticizing or insulting you.</i>	<i>I have the right to have my feelings acknowledged and I commit to acknowledging your feelings, e.g.:</i> <i>• anger or frustration (as long as it is not threatening)</i> <i>• love</i> <i>• desire for reassurance</i>
<i>I have the right to make suggestions, and for those suggestions to be given due consideration, without the assumption of an insult. I commit to give due consideration to your suggestions without assuming they are an insult.</i>	<i>I have the right to disengage from an argument if I am concerned it might get out of hand and I commit to your right to disengage from an argument if you are concerned it might get out of hand.</i>
<i>I have the right to expect that I will not be physically or verbally intimidated and I commit to your right to expect that I will not be physically or verbally intimidating towards you.</i>	<i>I have the right to make mistakes without undue criticism and I commit to your right to make mistakes without unduly criticizing you.</i>

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